User Manual



Xiffects Live

Saxophone & voice multi-effect
English edition • 25 October 2026
Interface revision: 90b6ecf

Start with your own sound

Xiffects Live is a real-time audio effect, not a sound generator. It combines nine modules, monophonic pitch correction, 50 complete factory presets, editable note permissions, tempo-synchronised delay and four algorithmic reverb characters.

Quick start

Insert the plug-in on an audio track. Select Clean - No effects, enable input monitoring in your host and begin at a comfortable listening level. Enable one module at a time. Use OUTPUT to match listening levels before comparing sounds.

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Installation & routing

Windows: VST3

Close the audio host before replacing an installed version. Extract the download and copy the entire Xiffects Live.vst3 bundle, including its internal folders, into C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3. Reopen the host, rescan plug-ins and insert Xiffects Live as an audio effect. Back up existing sessions first.

macOS: VST3 or AU

Copy the complete .vst3 bundle to ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3 or the .component bundle to ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components. Restart or rescan the host. Current macOS packages are unsigned; OS security checks may prevent loading. Use only trusted builds and follow your system's security guidance. Do not change system-wide security settings just to load a plug-in.

Standalone and mobile

In Standalone, choose the audio device, input and output through the application's device controls. Grant microphone permission where requested. Android is a debug ARM64 application, not a desktop VST. iOS/iPadOS packages contain the app/AUv3 extension but are unsigned build outputs, not installable signed IPA files; signing and provisioning are required. Device and GarageBand compatibility must be checked on actual hardware.

Mono, stereo and monitoring

Use a mono or stereo audio track. Avoid monitoring the direct input and delayed plug-in output simultaneously when checking timbre; parallel paths can create comb filtering. Start with conservative gain and avoid feeding speakers back into an open microphone. Mute before changing hardware routes.

Latency

Live reports 531, 578 and 1154 samples at 44.1, 48 and 96 kHz respectively: about 12 ms of nominal software delay. Host buffers, interfaces and monitoring add further delay. These figures are not measured physical roundtrip latency; pitch acquisition also takes time.

Presets & interface

Neutral starting point

Fresh Live instances have effects disabled, flat EQ and 0 dB OUTPUT. Clean - No effects resets parameters to a neutral starting point. Saved sessions intentionally retain their previous settings. Resetting parameters is not an instantaneous flush of effect buffers; allow the smooth parameter transition to settle.

50 factory sounds

Choose a named preset in the top menu. The < and > buttons move through the factory bank and wrap at its ends. Factory presets restore complete parameter recipes, so changing preset can also change output level, key, scale and note permissions. The extra Clean entry is separate from the 50 factory recipes.

Save and load

SAVE writes a .xiffects parameter snapshot; LOAD restores a compatible snapshot. Host projects also store plug-in parameters. These are settings, not recorded audio or frozen reverb tails. Save a copy before replacing a favourite sound. A file chooser may be cancelled without changing the sound.

Controls and bypass

The small button in each module enables or bypasses that effect. The top ON button controls global processing; bypass remains delay-compensated rather than removing the reported delay. OUTPUT ranges from -24 to +12 dB. IN and OUT meters show peak levels; orange warns of high level. Parameters support host automation and are smoothed to reduce abrupt changes.

Settings and mobile pages

The ... menu offers 80%, 100% and 120% desktop sizes and About. About includes the product description and artist/programmer contacts. Mobile uses touch pages and a module selector to access the same processing controls. The note keyboard edits permissions; it is not a MIDI instrument keyboard.

Dynamics, tone & harmony

Compressor

THRESHOLD: -60 to 0 dB. RATIO: 1:1 to 20:1. MAKEUP: 0 to 18 dB. The compressor reduces peaks above the threshold; use makeup conservatively. Attack and release are internal fixed settings, not exposed controls. In Live, detection follows the delayed pitch-bank signal so gain reduction follows the signal being compressed.

EQ

LOW, MID, HIGH and AIR each range from -12 to +12 dB. These are fixed tone bands, not a fully parametric equaliser with editable frequency or Q. Begin with small moves and compare at similar loudness. A saved preset may enable EQ even though a fresh Live instance does not.

Distortion

DRIVE, TONE and MIX range from 0 to 100%. DRIVE adds saturation; TONE changes the character and MIX blends the effect. Start with low drive and mix on acoustic saxophone. Added harmonics and altered timbre are intentional; distortion is not a transparent enhancement.

Octaver

SHIFT selects -2, -1, 0, +1 or +2 octaves. MIX controls the added voice from 0 to 100%. Begin around 10-20% for subtle support. Low notes and strong shifts can produce audible pitch-processing texture. Live harmony voices read the input in parallel rather than stacking a series of extra pitch delays.

Pitch Shifter

SHIFT ranges from -12 to +12 semitones; MIX ranges from 0 to 100%. Use it for octave or interval layers. This is a fixed interval, not an intelligent chord-following harmoniser. Large shifts can change the character of the reed or voice; formants are not preserved.

Space & movement

Reverb

The compact selector offers Room, Hall, Plate and Chamber. These are algorithmic characters, not sampled physical rooms or convolution IRs. MIX: 0-100%; SIZE: 0-100%; DECAY: 0.1-10 seconds. Start with low mix for natural sax. Changing mode is crossfaded, but a sustained tail can still change character.

Delay: manual time

With SYNC off, TIME sets 0.01-2 seconds. MIX sets 0-100% and FEEDBACK sets 0-95%. Feedback repeats and reinforces the delayed signal; high settings can build up energy. Reduce feedback and output if the sound becomes excessive.

Delay: host sync

With SYNC on, the rhythmic division and host tempo determine delay time instead of the manual TIME knob. Divisions are 1/16, 1/8 T, 1/8, 1/8 D, 1/4 T, 1/4, 1/4 D and 1/2. T means triplet; D means dotted. The BPM readout indicates when the 120 BPM fallback is being used because the host supplies no valid tempo.

Tempo behaviour

The supported tempo calculation is clamped to 30-300 BPM; the longest synced interval is 4 seconds. Sync follows tempo, not a guaranteed transport-phase lock. Time changes are smoothed and can create a pitch glide in existing echoes. A sustained note is a useful way to hear this behaviour before performing.

Phaser

RATE: 0.05-8 Hz. DEPTH and FEEDBACK: 0-100%. Low rates create slow movement; higher depth/feedback makes the effect more pronounced. This intentionally changes phase and tone. Keep it bypassed when comparing a dry recording for transparency.

Pitch correction & scales

A monophonic processor

Auto Tune is designed for one clear note at a time. The analysis range is approximately 100-1600 Hz. Chords, multiphonics, breath noise and unstable attacks may confuse detection. A visual pitch trace is an estimate, not a calibrated tuner or proof of perceptual sound quality.

Key, scale and permissions

Choose the musical KEY and SCALE, then use the note buttons to permit or exclude notes. The 44 choices are twelve-tone equal-tempered note maps, including Custom/Manual and named aliases. Cultural scale names do not imply microtonal cents tuning; this version does not implement arbitrary microtonal offsets. Leave at least one suitable note permitted.

Strength and speed

STRENGTH ranges from 0 to 100% and controls the amount of movement toward the selected target. Fractional values give partial correction. RETUNE ranges from 1 to 100 ms; smaller values react faster and may sound more synthetic. It is not the plug-in's reported latency or the total time needed to detect a new note.

Mix versus strength

For a single corrected voice, begin with MIX at 100% and adjust STRENGTH. A partial MIX blends the dry and pitch-shifted voices and can produce beating or a doubled sound. Fresh Live instances use 100% Tune Mix, but Auto Tune remains off until enabled; existing presets may use different values.

Natural starting point

Try a clean sustained note, a suitable key/scale, 20-40% strength and 30-60 ms retune. These are starting suggestions, not new factory defaults. Increase correction gradually and listen to attacks and vibrato. Pitch processing is granular and does not preserve formants or guarantee artifact-free extreme shifts.

Troubleshooting & contacts

No sound or plug-in not found

Check track input, monitoring, routing, mute/solo, device selection and microphone permission. Confirm the host supports the installed format and architecture. Copy whole bundles, then rescan. Test a fresh session before changing an existing project. Unsigned mobile output is not an installed AUv3 application.

Changed tone, clipping or doubling

Select Clean - No effects and compare at matched level after the smooth transition. Check that only one monitoring path is active. Disable other inserts for diagnosis. Lower input/output and effect makeup if peaks overload. The processed path has a safety ceiling; transparency above 0 dBFS is not promised. For correction without a doubled voice, use 100% Tune Mix and reduce Strength instead.

Wrong notes or unusual echoes

Check key, scale, note permissions, input clarity and register. Polyphonic material is not a supported correction target. For delay, inspect SYNC, division and the BPM/fallback display. A host that supplies no tempo uses 120 BPM. Existing projects keep their saved values, not new-instance defaults.

Verification and limitations

Automated DSP, host-state, preset, pitch, latency-compensated null and interface tests help catch regressions. Passing tests is not proof of zero bugs, compatibility with every host, or real-device performance. A final quality judgement needs listening to real sax/voice recordings and testing on the intended system. Keep backups before upgrading.

About and contact

Artist IG @Xivan_original
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When reporting a problem, include the build revision, platform, host, sample rate, preset/settings and reproducible steps. If possible, provide short dry and processed recordings that you have permission to share.